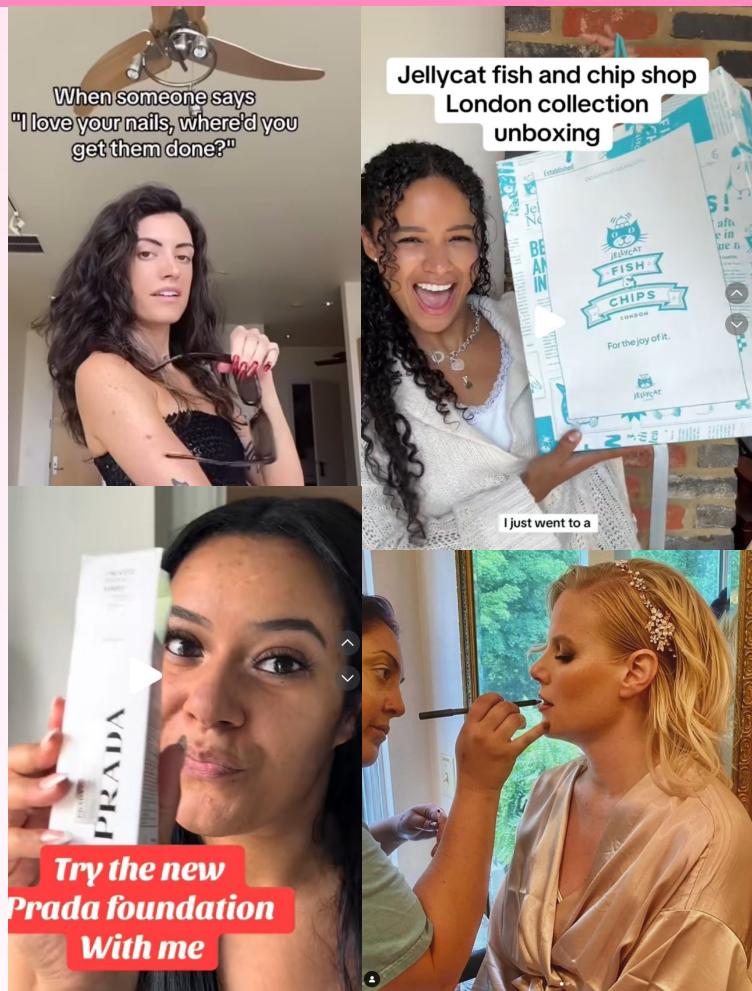


FT Influencers & Businesses: Beauty, fashion and lifestyle

What opportunities can we unlock for FT's editor?

UR Team August '24 

Magali Lifschitz



What is the purpose of this research?

- **To help innovate + refine H2 feature planning and overall strategy for the editor**
- **To stay ahead of the curve, we are uncovering evolving needs + expectations of image editing tech**
- **This study was focused on influencers + biz, as they are trendsetters in the market and frequent users**

17 Facetune users were interviewed

Audience

1. **Influencers:**
 - a. both aspiring + experienced w a following (+20K)
 - b. Beauty, Fashion and/or Lifestyle influencers
2. **Beauty & Fashion Businesses**

Research Questions:

1. How do influencers + businesses utilize FT and other photo editing apps? What motivates their editing decisions?
2. What pain points do users face with FT and other app to find opportunities for FT?



When someone says
"I love your nails, where'd you
get them done?"



RATING MAKEUP FROM
ALIEXPRESS PT.1
: ❤️🍷CALLCALLING
BABY ANGEL PALLETTE
🍷❤️



Try the new
Prada foundation
With me



WILL THIS BE YOUR
NEW FAVORITE LIPSTICK??



Garden Series
episode 3



Jellycat fish and chip shoes
London collection
unboxing

I just went to a

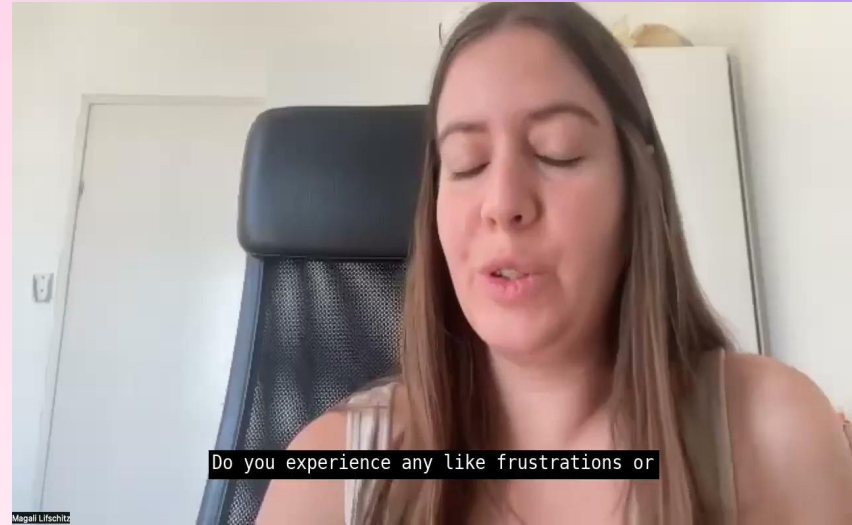


- AMAZON -
favorite



BIGGEST drive in choosing photo edits is staying 'natural' → crucial for credibility + authenticity

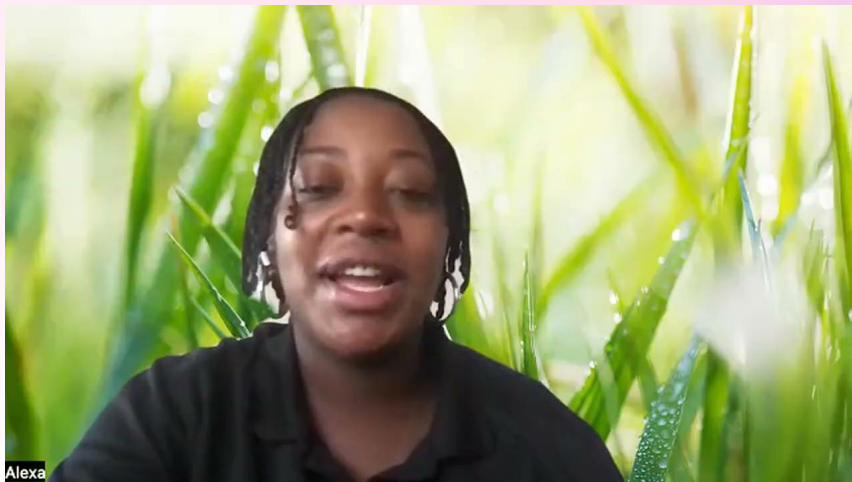
- This audience has professional/ social implication concerns w. over-edited photos so FT is for small tweaks not compromising real-life appearance



*P16, Devyn, 23, influencer + content creator for NFL
@itsdevyntaylorr*

Making realistic edits IS both the #1 pain point and the #1 benefit of FT manual/ toggle features

- Users typically make minimal adjustments, favoring lower intensity settings and avoiding "looks" to maintain a natural appearance



P6, Alexa G, biz owner, 30, @eleven03.shop

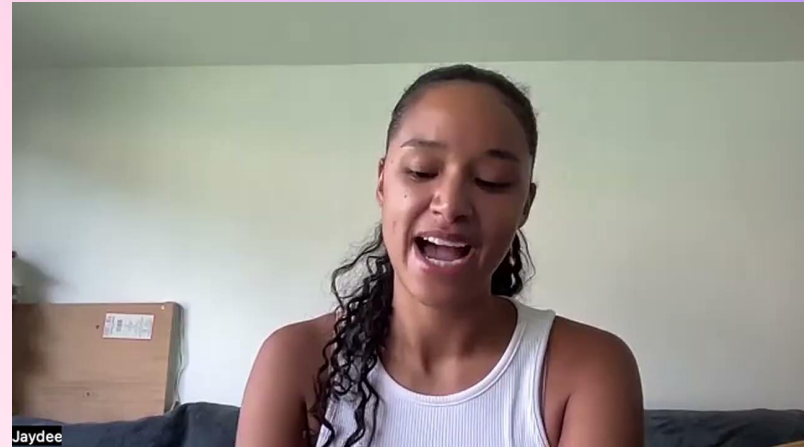
There's frustration with FT's 'looks' + makeup features as they don't adapt well to different face angles + fail to match user's natural look

- *"That feature isn't meant for me"* → a common frustration with edits that alter natural appearances (overly lightening skin, slimming of nose, etc.)
- This uniformity in edits further leads users to easily recognize Facetune edits online, discouraging usage to maintain individuality
- Users want to edit makeup as naturally as they would apply it IRL

Videos: "natural look"



"FT's makeup don't adapt well with my features"
P14, Christen T, influencer, 35, @Christenallyssa



Using CapCut instead of FT for makeup edits
P12, Jaydee, influencer, 34, @jaymfs (on TikTok)

Recommendation #1: 'natural look'

1. **Prioritize natural edits:** enhance and expand range of subtler adjustments options especially for makeup features
 - **Consider changing titles** (UXW) to highlight the "natural" aspects of features to make them more appealing
2. **Inclusivity: Improve tech to better fit ALL skin + facial features**
 - Consider implementing a **research protocol** that ensures a specific percentage of minority groups are included in data sets used for training models
3. **Personalized makeup editing feature:**
 - Get makeup preferences ahead of time (i.e. face scan or make up product survey) to replicate their real-life makeup look

~ General User Journey for Influencers + Biz ~

Inspo: before entering app

1. Picking an image from several
2. Noticing imperfection on image
3. Seeing online editing trends or edits from people in industry

FT use

1. Using FT intentionally (not exploratory)
2. Going to familiar features first/ keeping edits consistent
3. Search features based on a specific need
4. Used mostly for face + body

Other apps use

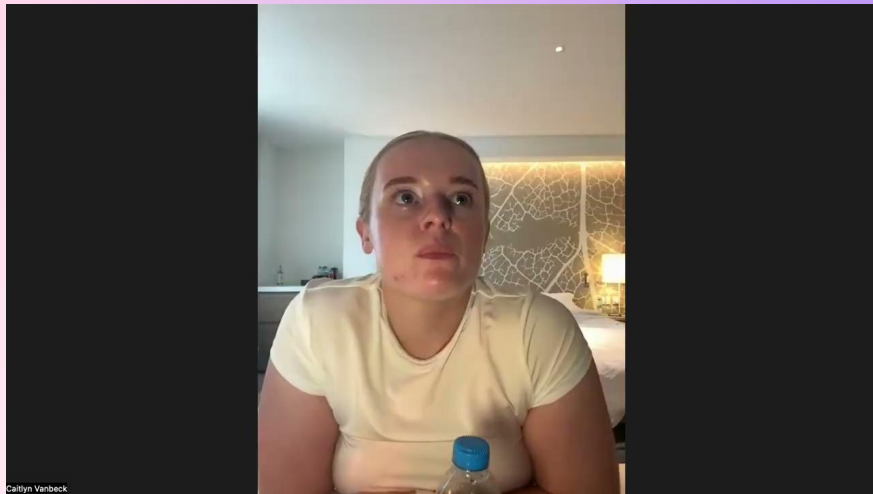
1. General adjustments: native phone edits, insta, etc.
2. Specialized filters/ lighting: VSCO/ Taza + Lightroom
3. Adding/ removing design elements: Canva/ Photoshop

Posting

1. Posting images on social media and websites
2. Posting as a thumbnail for videos online

!! Users are entering FT already with clear intentions on specific editing goals + using familiar features → meaning they are *not exploring*

- Even when users **search for new features**, it comes AFTER using typical features and is driven by a **specific editing need**, rather than a desire to explore for its own sake
- **Time-constraints + familiarity** is a big reason for using same edits



P9, Caitlyn, influencer, 26, @caitlynvanbeck

P11, Kayla, influencer, 30, @kaylawmochi

Maintaining a consistent aesthetic to preserve brand identity is important to be easily recognized

Insight also found here: [SMBs UR](#)



*P12 Jaydee, influencer, 34 @jaymfs (tiktok)
P8 Meagan, biz owner, 36, @pennluckshoes*

Users *want* the speed + convenience of auto features *but* are currently using more manual tools for a realistic + personalized look

Other considerations when choosing auto vs manual:

1. **Task-dependent:** users select editing features based on specific tasks
2. **Detail-oriented:** users requiring higher precision use manual features
3. **Time Constraints:** Busy users (i.e. biz owners) prefer automated features
4. **Skill level:** Users less confident in editing skills prefer automated features

Recommendation #2: Intent-driven edits

1. **AI personalization tool** that learns user past editing behaviors of their familiar edits to apply them to new images
2. **Tools redistribution to help users discover new features:**
Introduce a 'favorites' section and a 'new features' section. By being able to quickly access their most-used tools, we have an opportunity to also highlight new tools
3. **Bulk editing** of several images at the simultaneously to save time and preserve consistency in editing

The main goal + challenge w. editing is creating content that stands out and captures attention

- Engaging image creation and consistent posting of unique content are major challenges in a saturated, algo-driven market.



P9, Caitlyn, influencer, 26, @caitlynvanbeck
P4, Braelinn, biz owner, 33, @rave_nailz
P1, Samira, influencer, 25, @sams_weird_world
P15, Megan, Biz Owner, 35, @foreplaygolf_

There are initial signs of increasing adoption of AI tools amongst this audience

- Some users from this audience are already using AI today:
 - Background removal and modifying image elements with AI on **Photoshop and Canva**
 - Influencer using **CapCut's AI makeup** filters for videos
 - Biz owner uses a website called **Botika for AI-generated models**
 - Makeup artist draws **inspiration** from AI to create makeup looks
 - **Chat GPT** for captions and inspiration of ideas

Despite current skepticism with AI, users expect AI to improve with time and hope it will help them deliver quick and effective content



P4, Braelinn, biz owner, 33, @rave_nailz

*P5, Dianne, influencer/ content creator for others, 25
@TeminaSemo @braidingnairobi
@natachionwamagebeu @spadeaspade studios
and @onlyomoke*

There is appreciation for AI potential to streamline editing processes but users still want to retain creative control

- Users prefer AI that assists rather than *fully* automates
- Similar insight seen in: [\[UR Report\] SMBs Content Automation](#)



P7, Tovie, Influencer, 19, @toviierari (IG) @morarii (TT)

Recommendation #3: Standing out

- **AI assistant** that offers personalized editing suggestions from their specific markets, aimed at enhancing image to ensure content stands out for their audiences
 - **Important note:** with ai tools we need to have dynamic feedback systems that allow users to have control by letting them adjust their preferences, suggestions, market changes, etc.

Strong perception that FT is ONLY for face & body edits and not general adjustments/filters

- Users are either unaware of other features or find them unappealing because they are basic or unrealistic
(insight also found in: [Churn - user research](#))
- This further limits their exploration and use of other features

******Minority of business owners/ experienced influencers use FT to highlight their products and fix imperfections in the backgrounds

Videos: perception of FT

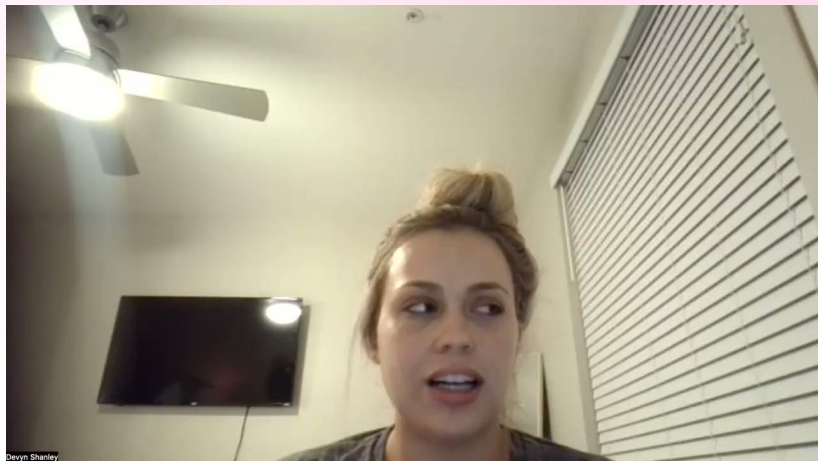


P2, Angela, Influencer, 31, @angelovesxfashion (TT)

There is a BIG evolution in how users are editing their images overall for social media →

1. Less heavily edited + perfected images (also found in: [Churn - user research](#))
2. From selfies → to full-body or broader scenes
3. From heavy, unrealistic filters → to lighting adjustment or specialized filters
4. Less images → more videos
5. Some are incorporating AI edits

Videos: evolution of editing



*P16, Devyn, 23, influencer + content creator for NFL
@itsdevyntaylorr
P9 Caitlyn, Influencer, 26, @caitlynvanbeck*



*Stop subscribing to FT; doesn't take "selfies" as much
P5, Dianne, influencer/ content creator for others, 25
@TeminaSemo @braidingnairobi
@natachionwamagebeu @spadeaspade studios
and @onlyomoke*

The decisive factor for subscribing and maintaining a subscription is value of features

- Evaluating the cost-effectiveness of an app is based on quality of features and how frequently they will use it long term
- Other considerations for obtaining a subscription (not maintaining): industry recs and app's ease of use as several are not editing experts

This audience is frustrated with having more than one editing app because they subscribe to them

- This pain point mainly affects biz + influencer audience who ARE paying for advanced editing apps, and it is less of a pain point for those NOT paying within this audience
- From other URs we also see that the broader Facetune user base is fine with using free apps/ native iPhone editing



*P8, Meagan, biz owner, 36, @pennluckshoes
P2, Angela, influencer, 31, @angelovesxfashion (TT)*

Users mainly use other apps for specialized filters, lighting and adding design elements

Some examples mentioned in this study's sample are:

- **VSCO + Taza:** have variety of high-quality, specialized filters
- **Adobe Lightroom:** Fixing lighting
- **Canva:** ability to add design elements/text, change backgrounds, delete components and used by several to keep content consistent
- **Photoshop:** used instead of FT for extensive editing, i.e. for ads instead of social media

Experienced influencers tailor their images to specific moods or brands vibe

- This is to create audience connection



P12, Jaydee, Influencer, 34, @jaymfs (TT)

P14, Christen, Influencer, 35, @christenallyssa

Recommendation #4: FT Perspective

- **IF we are focusing on this audience– enhance + invest in FT's broader capabilities** like enhanced lighting, specialized filters, adding design elements, and background edits
 - After enhancing FT's broader capabilities, then make **non face + body features more discoverable through** integrated tutorials/ feature highlights

Recs summary + strategic direction: What to explore further?

Priority   

Integrating AI tools:

1. **Personalization:** learn user's past edits to apply familiar edits to new images
2. **AI assistant:** personalized suggestions to enhance images and ensure content stands in their markets
3. **Makeup personalization:** Get info ahead of time on *current makeup preferences* to replicate real-life look

Priority   

Natural Look:

1. **Prioritize natural edits** by expanding subtler adjustment options, especially the makeup features.
2. **Consider renaming features** to highlight 'natural' aspects
3. **Inclusivity:** Improve tech to suit ALL skin + facial features by *mandating a specific minority representation* in training data sets.

Priority   

FT broader capabilities:

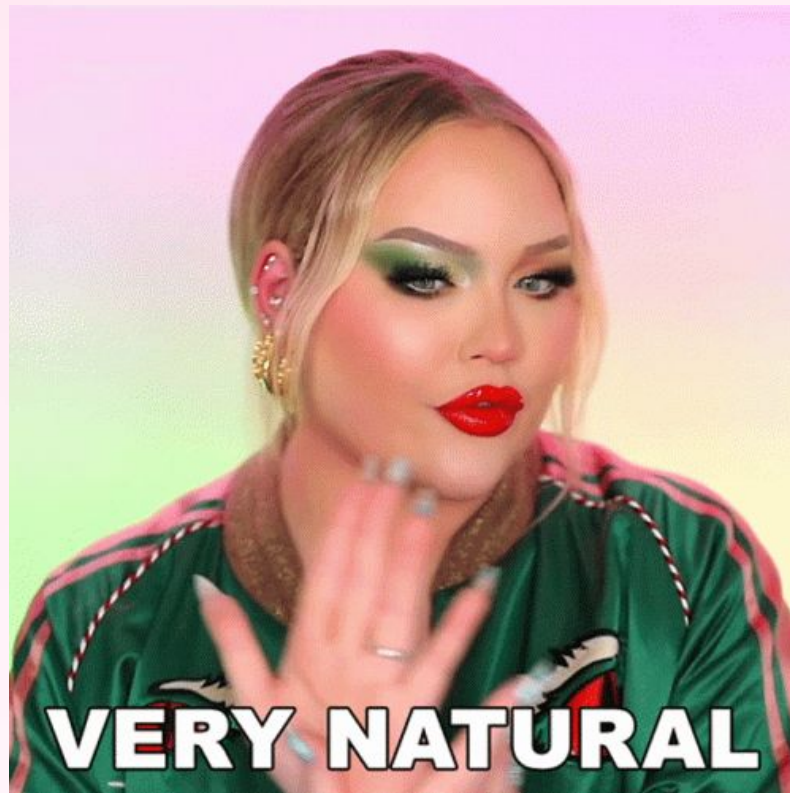
IF we're focusing on this audience: Enhance FT's features beyond face/body
i.e. specialized filters, color/exposure adjustments + add elements, background edits

Familiar edits + feature discover

1. **Tools redistribution:** Introduce a 'favorites' section and a 'new features' section.
2. **Bulk editing** for multiple images

Thank you!

Questions,
comments, ideas?
Slack Magali 



Appendix

Audience:

	Name	Influencer or biz	Age	Online handles
P1	Samira N	Influencer: Aspiring	25	Instagram: @sams_weird_world
P2	Angela H	Influencer: Aspiring	31	youtube: travelchosome, tiktok: angielovesxfashion
P3	Cheryl F	Biz owner: Makeup + Skin	60	IG: @beyoutifulyouwithcheryl TT-@cherylfeldman1 Website-www.senegence.com/cheryl
P4	Braelinn F	Biz owner: Press on nails	33	IG: @rave_nailz @braelinn @brae.ns TT: @braelInn @ravenailz
P5	Dianne	Influencer/ social media manager for experienced influencers	25	@diannesaliamo and social media manager for @TeminaSemo @braidingnairobi @natashionwamagebeu @spadeaspade studios and @onlyomoke
P6	Alexa G	Biz Owner: Clothes	30	Instagram: @eleven03.shop website: www.eleven03.shop
P7	Tovie O	Influencer: Aspiring	19	Instagram: @toviierei TikTok: @morarii
P8	Meagan	Biz Owner: Shoes	36	@luckymeagan @pennluckshoes www.pennyluckshoes.com
P9	Caitlyn	Influencer: Experienced w following	26	Instagram : @caitlynvanbeck TikTok : @caitlynlvb Facebook: Caitlyn Vanbeck

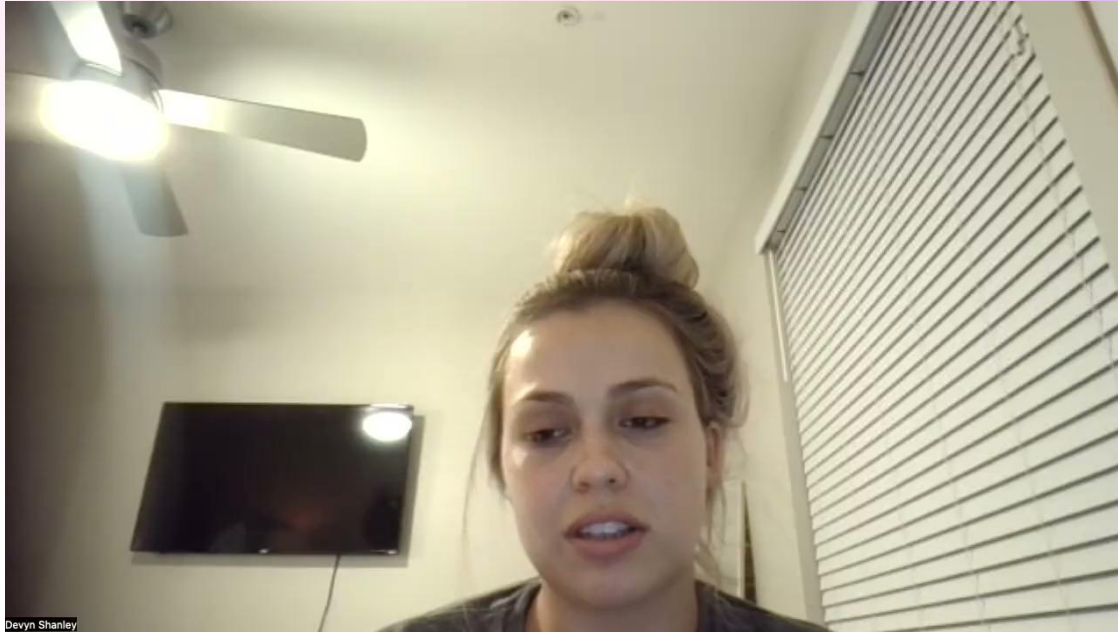
Audience:

	Name	Influencer or biz	Age	Online handles
P10	Valerie	Biz owner: Makeup Artist	37	@valerielouartistry and @violetflamebrain on instagram
P11	Kayla	Influencer: Experienced w following	30	@kaylawmochi (instagram)
P12	Jaydee	Influencer: Experienced w following	34	@jaymfs tiktok and YouTube
P13	Jessica	Influencer: Experienced w following	40	IG: @msjcastro TT: @msjcastro629
P14	Christen T	Influencer: Aspiring	35	@Christenallyssa
P15	Megan K	Biz owner: Women's golf clothes	34	@foreplaygolf_ ; https://www.foreplaygolf.com
P16	Devyn S	Influencer: Aspiring	23	@itsdevyntaylorr
P17	Adedoyin A	Biz owner: Bridal dresses	27	@Desoyesapparel_

Evolution of less editing positively impacts users' mental health, another reason users are editing less

Insight also found in why users churn on FT: [Churn – user research](#)

For this specific audience, there is a tension b/w maintaining a professional look and having more authentic, less edited images



Minority of users creatively use FT for video thumbnails, showing that even as trends shifts towards video content, FT can remain valuable



Influencers are motivated by following editing trends and others in their industry to stay relevant online

These users often resist new features or switching apps due to the daunting learning curve

- Although these are frequent editors, they're still not experts and prefer familiar tools